

Dez Miller

dez.miller@emory.edu • dezmilller.com

674 Federal Ter SE Atlanta, GA 30315 • 404-987-1804

Education

Ph.D. in Comparative Literature, Emory University Dissertation: <i>City Water: Stories of Urban Rivers</i> Certificate in Digital Humanities and Media Studies Committee members: Angelika Bammer (Chair) Lauren Klein Caroline Schaumann Dan Sinykin	May 2026 (expected)
Master of Fine Arts, Boston University <i>Tuition Remission</i>	2019
Master of Social Work, Washington University in St. Louis Concentration: Policy	2016
Bachelor of Arts, New York University French Major, Creative Writing Minor	2011

Areas of Study

Research Interests: Urban Ecology, Computational Literary Analysis, German Environmentalism, Critical AI

Competencies: Ecocriticism, Digital Humanities, Contemporary Literature, Language Theory, Creative Writing, Climate Fiction, Indigenous Studies, Science Fiction, East German Literature, Animal Studies, French Theory and Literature, Media Materialism

Peer-Reviewed Publications

“Who Speaks as AI?” <i>Comparative Literature Culture Web</i> , forthcoming	2025
“ Weelaunee and What a Creek Reveals : A Personal Narrative of the Early Stop Cop City Movement,” <i>Atlanta Studies</i>	2025
“ Searching for Latent River Cultures in English-language Literature Using Word Embeddings ,” <i>The Hungarian Journal of English and American Studies</i> , special issue called “The Digital Environmental Humanities. Toward Theory and Praxis.”	2024

Fellowships and Grants

Data and Decision Sciences Department	2025
Sixth-Year Fellowship, Laney Graduate School Stipend	-2026
Data Speculations National Forum Invited Participant, \$1K	2025
AIAI Seed Grant Funding, with collaborators, \$5K	2024

AIAI Seed Grant Funding, with collaborators, \$1K	2023
Mellon Humanities PhD. Program Interventions, \$2K	2023
Graduate Community of Digital Scholars, \$500	2023
Teaching Fellowship, Boston University, \$14,750	2019
The Leslie Epstein/Robert Pinsky Global Fellowship, \$4500	2019

Conference Presentations and Invited Talks

<i>Modern Language Association</i> (Toronto): “Reading the Cruelty of Water Hoarding in <i>Chinatown</i> (1974)” as part of special session “Ecocinema in the Late Twentieth Century” (panel organizer)	2026
<i>Modern Language Association</i> (Toronto): “‘Thinking Critically about Code’: Promoting Inter-Disciplinary Conversation through a Graduate Student-Led Workshop Series”	2026
<i>Association for the Study of Literature and the Environment</i> (virtual): “LA Riverine Atmospheres”	2025
<i>Data Speculations National Forum</i> (virtual): “Forging Research Paths in Computational Contemporary Literature Studies”	2025
<i>Computational Humanities Research</i> (Aarhus, Denmark): “Exploring Ecological Bias in Depictions of NYC Rivers in <i>The New York Times</i> ” (lightning talk)	2024
<i>Association for Computers and the Humanities</i> (virtual): “‘Stop Cop City’: Tracking Urban Ecological Discourse” (poster)	2024
<i>Digital Humanities</i> (Graz, Austria): “Modeling Eco-Poetics and Eco-Politics in 20 th Century Speculative Fiction: Toxic Water,” with collaborators	2023
<i>International Conference on Ecocriticism and Environmental Humanities</i> (virtual): “Water’s Persistent Spirituality in Jacques Roumain’s <i>Gouverneurs de la Rosée</i> ” (also presented at Emory Department of Comparative Literature Colloquium, 2023)	2022

Selected Work Experience and Research Assistantship

Team Member, AI and Social Movements, <i>AIAI Network</i>	2023 -present
Research Assistant for “ Has the DEI Backlash Come for Publishing? ” by Richard Jean So and Dan Sinykin. <i>The Atlantic</i> , June 19 2024	2026
Digital Scholarship Associate, Emory Center for Digital Scholarship	2022-2024
Editorial Assistant, <i>Debates in the Digital Humanities</i> (as part of Emory Center for Digital Scholarship work)	2023-2024

Courses Taught*(all self-designed and taught as instructor-of-record)*

CPLT 202: "Intro to Climate Fiction," Emory University	2026
CPLT 202: "Reading for Water," Emory University	2023
CPLT 202: "Digital Culture and the Anthropocene," Emory University	2023
CPLT 101: "The Internet as Rhetorical Space," Emory University	2022
EN 202: "Intro to Creative Writing," Boston University	2018

Selected Creative and Public Writing

"Word2Vec Modeling" on The SF Nexus	2024
" Stories from the End ," The Linden Review (initially published in The Matador Review, 2019)	2023
" Two Regenerating Poems ," <i>Always Crashing</i>	2019

Trainings

ECAS Certification to Teach Undergraduate English Language Learners	2022
Digital Humanities Summer Institute (virtual)	2022
NØ School Nevers (Nevers, France)	2022
CPLT 735/ENG 791 Composition Practicum, Emory University	2020
Pedagogy Workshops, Boston University	2018

University Service and Engagement

Steering Committee Member for the Thinking Critically about Code workshop series, a cross-Atlanta university collaboration	2023-2025
Member of the Graduate Community of Digital Scholars, Emory University	2023-2024
"Text Mining in the HathiTrust Digital Library" (workshop presentation, Emory Center for Digital Scholarship, virtual)	2024
Union Steward for the Department of Comparative Literature	2020-2024
Webmaster for EmoryUnite! (grad union) website	2021-2024
Treasurer for the Comparative Literature Seminar Series	2020-2021

Languages

English (Native), French (Fluent), Spanish (Intermediate), German (Beginner)